

Multiple Choice

1. **Answer:** A

Options: A) in a world where moral rules are constantly changing.; B) in a world in which everyone complied with those rules perfectly.; C) in an ideal institutional setting.; D) in a world where every individual creates their own rules.; E) in a setting where institutions are corrupted.

Note: The Ideal Moral Code theory posits that moral obligations are determined by the best possible moral rules, which must adapt to the complexities of human experience and societal evolution, thereby necessitating action in accordance with rules that may change over time.

2. **Answer:** A

Options: A) enhancement is always morally superior to treatment.; B) enhancement is inherently unnatural.; C) human beings have a moral duty to enhance themselves.; D) medical treatment is always more morally acceptable than enhancement.; E) there is no moral difference between treatment and enhancement.

Note: Kamm argues that Sandel's framework presupposes that enhancements, which go beyond basic treatment, are inherently better or more desirable, thereby neglecting the moral complexities and implications of such distinctions.

3. **Answer:** A

Options: A) instinctive behavior, such as nursing young.; B) irrational behavior.; C) involuntary operations such as heartbeat and breathing.; D) the physical actions and reactions of animals.; E) human behavior that is driven by basic needs.

Note: Hobbes refers to "animal motion" as instinctive behavior because he views such actions, including nursing young, as driven by natural impulses rather than conscious reasoning, reflecting his materialist perspective on human and animal behavior.

4. **Answer:** B

Options: A) the boundaries of our moral obligations.; B) the domain of our personal identity.; C) all of the above.; D) what we are free to do.; E) the responsibilities we have towards others.

Note: According to McGregor, rights are essential for defining and protecting the boundaries of individual identity, as they establish the framework within which personal autonomy and self-conception are realized.

5. **Answer:** A

Options: A) agent-relative.; B) agent-neutral.; C) absolute.; D) none of the above.

Note: Parfit argues that the obligation to prioritize one's children's welfare is agent-relative because it is grounded in the special moral relationship and responsibilities that parents have towards their own children, which differ from the impartial obligations one might have towards others.

True / False

6. **Answer:** True

Options: A) True; B) False

Note: Kant argues that a good will is intrinsically valuable because it acts out of a sense of duty and moral law, making it the only quality that can be deemed good unconditionally, independent of its consequences or external factors.

7. **Answer:** True

Options: A) True; B) False

Note: Gauthier argues that practical rationality is grounded in logical justification because he believes that rational decision-making must be underpinned by coherent reasoning that aligns with normative principles.

8. **Answer:** False

Options: A) True; B) False

Note: Reiman argues that van den Haag's support for capital punishment undermines human rights and ethical treatment by advocating for a punitive approach that disregards the dignity and worth of individuals.

9. **Answer:** True

Options: A) True; B) False

Note: Reiman argues that van den Haag's rationale for supporting the death penalty, which emphasizes deterrence and retribution, could logically extend to justifying extreme punitive measures like death by torture as a more effective means of achieving those ends.

10. **Answer:** True

Options: A) True; B) False

Note: Moral nihilism posits that there are no inherent moral truths or values, which implies that moral considerations are irrelevant and do not apply to any context, including war.

Long Form Response

11. **Answer:** In her alternative version of the violinist case, Judith Thomson argues that while one may have a moral obligation to allow the violinist to use their kidneys for an hour, this obligation does not equate to the violinist having a right to do so. The distinction lies in the difference between moral duty and rights; one can acknowledge that helping another is a commendable act without conceding that the person has a claim to one's body. Thomson uses this scenario to illustrate that moral considerations do not automatically translate into entitlements. Therefore, while it may be virtuous to assist the violinist, this does not justify the imposition of a right over one's bodily autonomy. This nuanced understanding highlights the complexity of moral obligations versus rights, emphasizing that ethical responsibilities do not necessarily confer ownership or claims over one's body.

Note: correct because it highlights Thomson's critical distinction between moral obligations to assist others and the lack of an inherent right for someone to use another person's bodily resources, emphasizing that moral duty does not equate to a claim of entitlement.

12. **Answer:** The construction of the first Buddhist temple in Japan in 596 CE marked a pivotal moment in the country's cultural and philosophical landscape. This event facilitated the introduction of Buddhist teachings and practices, which began to intertwine with indigenous Shinto beliefs, leading to a unique syncretism that shaped Japanese spirituality. The temple served not only as a place of worship but also as a center for learning and the arts, fostering a cultural renaissance that influenced literature, architecture, and ethical thought. As Buddhism spread, it encouraged new perspectives on morality, suffering, and the nature of existence, profoundly affecting Japanese philosophical discourse and societal values for centuries to come. Thus, the establishment of the temple can be seen as a foundational moment that initiated a transformative journey in Japan's philosophical evolution.

Note: correct because it emphasizes the transformative role of the first Buddhist temple in 596 CE as a catalyst for the integration of Buddhist and Shinto beliefs, which in turn fostered a cultural renaissance that significantly influenced Japanese philosophy and the arts.